

MODULE 01

STUDENT DOWNLOAD | SHOP-FLOOR WORKBOOK

The Real Role of an Estimator

A practical responsibility map and pre-estimate checklist that helps you think like a profit protector, not just a price taker.

Estimating is not clerical work. It is strategy, risk control, and production planning before production starts.

Use this immediately after watching the module. The goal is not paperwork for the sake of paperwork. The goal is to slow down the quote just enough to stop missed cost, unclear responsibility, and margin loss before the job is won.

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WORKSHEET

Estimator Responsibility Map

Use this before pricing. Your job is to protect the business by understanding what the work will actually take.

AREA	ESTIMATOR QUESTION	NOTES / DECISION
Scope	What exactly are we providing, and where does our responsibility stop?	
Buildability	Can the shop actually fabricate this as drawn without hidden handling or sequence problems?	
Field Reality	What will the installer need: access, lift, crane, anchors, layout, shutdowns, or other trades?	
Risk	What could change the cost after award?	
Quote Protection	What assumption, exclusion, alternate, or clarification needs to be written down?	

WORKSHEET

Quick Estimate vs. Real Estimate

Use quick rules only as a first pass or cross-check. Use bottom-up build when there is enough detail to price the job properly.

ESTIMATE STAGE	USE WHEN	BEST USE	DANGER
Parametric / rule of thumb	Early screening or budget range	Fast sanity check	Can hide unique scope and risk
Comparable past job	Similar job, similar shop, similar site	Reality check	Past job may not match this job
Bottom-up build	Bid-stage or detailed estimate	Real pricing by material, labour, subs, equipment, risk	Takes more time but protects profit
Final bid review	Before quote is sent	Tests cost, risk, scope, margin, and quote language	Skipping this sends mistakes to the customer

WORKSHEET

Pre-Estimate Profit Protection Checklist

Check each item before you trust the number.

CHECK	YES / NO / NOTES
Drawings and revisions are identified	
Major scope items are separated by deliverable	
Hidden handling, setup, trucking, paint/galv, install, and equipment are considered	
Assumptions are written down, not kept in someone's head	
Risk items are priced, clarified, excluded, transferred, reserved, or negotiated	
Final price includes overhead and target margin	
Quote wording protects the number	

WORKSHEET

Student Action

Take one real or sample job. Write three hidden costs and three assumptions that would protect the quote.

HIDDEN COST / ASSUMPTION	WHY IT MATTERS	HOW I WILL HANDLE IT

WORKSHEET

Apply This To A Real Job

Use the space below to connect the lesson to an actual estimate you are working on.

APPLY THIS TO MY NEXT ESTIMATE	NOTES
One thing I will use immediately	
One question I need to ask before I price	

APPLY THIS TO MY NEXT ESTIMATE	NOTES
One assumption, exclusion, or clarification I should write down	
Extra notes / reminders	